ERA 20

The Movement Peaks

1963 – 1965

The March on Washington · landmark civil rights laws

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the civil rights movement translate protest into permanent law?

KEY TERMS

The March on Washington · the Civil Rights Act of 1964 · Selma · the Voting Rights Act of 1965

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 8.10 · AMSCO Ch. 8.10

FROM PROTEST TO LAW

The Movement Peaks

August 28, 1963

The March on Washington



- In August 1963, some **250,000** people gathered at the Lincoln Memorial.
- **Dr. King** delivered his '**I Have a Dream**' speech.
- It was the largest demonstration the capital had ever seen—and a moral turning point.

The Civil Rights Act of 1964

- After Kennedy's assassination, President **Johnson** pushed the bill through Congress.
- The **Civil Rights Act of 1964** banned segregation in **public accommodations**.
- It outlawed **discrimination** in employment based on race, sex, religion, or origin.



SECTION

The Right to Vote

Selma & the Voting Rights Act



- In **Selma**, marchers demanding the vote were beaten on '**Bloody Sunday**.'
- Televised violence shocked the nation into action.
- The **Voting Rights Act of 1965** banned literacy tests and protected Black voters.

What the Movement Won

I

End of Legal Segregation

The **Civil Rights Act** outlawed Jim Crow in public life.

II

The Right to Vote

The **Voting Rights Act** and 24th Amendment restored Black voting power.

III

A Model for the World

Nonviolent protest became a template for movements everywhere.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Movement Peaks

1. The **March on Washington** and King's '**I Have a Dream**' speech marked the movement's moral peak.
2. The **Civil Rights Act of 1964** outlawed segregation and **discrimination**.
3. After **Selma**, the **Voting Rights Act of 1965** secured the ballot—dismantling the legal structure of Jim Crow.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Movement Peaks

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how nonviolent protest pressured Congress to pass landmark **civil rights laws**.

COMPARISON

Compare the **Civil Rights Act of 1964** and the **Voting Rights Act of 1965**.

ARGUMENTATION

Was federal **legislation** or grassroots **protest** more essential to the movement's success? Defend a claim.

Up next — **Lesson 50: Black Power & a Movement Divided**